



AP

Gill's gesture and the Kohli complex

After India's loss to England in the opening Test at Leeds, a former England cricketer remarked that Shubman Gill lacked the persona and aura of Virat Kohli. Perhaps Gill took that as a challenge to prove that there was indeed some Kohli in him.

On the eve of the Edgbaston Test, a British journalist sitting just behind the Diary pointed out to Gill that India had never won a Test at that ground in eight attempts. Gill's response was measured.

He said he had the best Indian team, that they would not be weighed down by history, and would strive to chart a new path. But his actions after India's historic 336-run win seemed to undo all the good work. When someone asked him about breaking the Edgbaston jinx, Gill, grinning, said he wanted to meet "that favourite journalist" of his and pretended to



SHUBMAN GILL SHARED A LIGHT-HEARTED MOMENT IN THE POST-MATCH PRESS CONFERENCE, PLAYFULLY TROLLING THE JOURNALIST WHO HAD HIGHLIGHTED INDIA'S POOR RECORD AT EDGBASTON BEFORE THE MATCH



look around the room searching for him.

For the Diary, it felt needless. The journalist had merely stated a fact, not thrown down a gauntlet. The Diary was reminded of the days when Kohli, in true Jose Mourinho fashion, revelled in a siege mentality. Gill, who still sports a boyish look, doesn't seem cut out for such theatrics. In a match where his bat did all the talking — a double-century and a hundred — what additional point was he trying to make? The Diary is still searching for a non-Kohli explanation.

N. Sudarshan